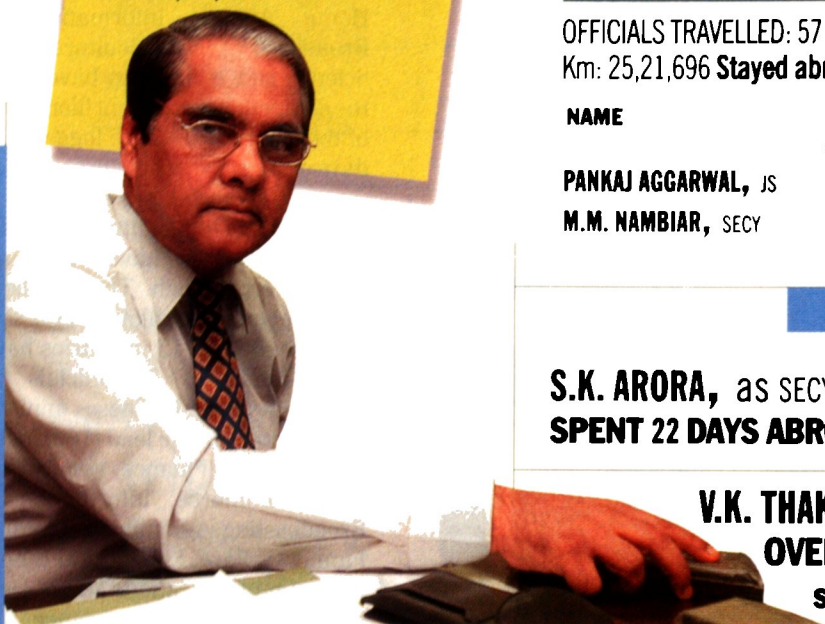


R.V. SHAHI, FORMER SECY,
POWER, **SPENT 69 DAYS**
ABROAD, spending
Rs 33,08,411.



50 officials of Urban Development Ministry stayed 656 DAYS overseas, spending Rs 55,00,343 while travelling 13,00,296 km.

Communications and IT

OFFICIALS TRAVELLED: 57 Expenses: Rs 2,71,24,538
Km: 25,21,696 Stayed abroad: 863 days

NAME	DAYS SPENT ABROAD	NO OF TRIPS	EXPENSES (In Rs)
PANKAJ AGGARWAL, JS	105	19	43,06,048
M.M. NAMBIAR, SECY	89	20	45,60,005

S.K. ARORA, as SECY, INFORMATION AND BROADCASTING,
SPENT 22 DAYS ABROAD. Total Cost: Rs 31,96,590.

V.K. THAKRAL, JS, MINES, **WAS**
OVERSEAS FOR 18 DAYS and
spent Rs 26,69,663.

48 officials of Statistics and Programme Implementation

were overseas for 438 days. They travelled 12,09,818 km costing the exchequer Rs 50,23,422.

SURYA P. SETHI, PRINCIPAL ADVISER, PLANNING, **STAYED 142 DAYS ABROAD and spent Rs 30,45,944.**

Information gathered by INDIA TODAY shows that along with S.N. Menon (37 trips), Chandrapal (9), T.K. Viswanathan (7), P.K. Misra (8), V. Subramanian (10), Naresh Dayal (6), Ranjit Issar (5), M.S. Srinivasan (8), R.V. Shahi (15), Radha Singh (8), T. Nanda Kumar (6) travelled frequently as secretaries in the ministries of Commerce; Small and Micro Enterprises; Law and Justice; Agriculture; New and Renewable Energy; Health and Family Welfare; Housing; and Urban Poverty Alleviation; Petroleum and Natural Gas; Power; Agriculture and Consumer Affairs respectively.

When the minister and secretary of a department are required to visit abroad, the prime minister is supposed to be notified. Officials visiting foreign shores get a daily allowance of \$75 per day in category A countries in addition to their hotel accommodation. If the food is provided by the Government, the official gets only 25 per cent of this amount. Secretary-

level officials travel first class, additional secretaries and joint secretaries are entitled to travel business class while officials of lower ranks are entitled to travel by the economy class.

Approvals for foreign visits are clearly defined. Travels of officials up to the level of joint secretary are processed in consultation with the financial adviser of the concerned ministry while foreign trips of officials of the level of additional secretaries and above are processed with the approval of the minister concerned and the screening committee of secretaries under the chairmanship of the cabinet secretary.

In addition, every government servant is required to obtain a No Objection Certificate from his office before acquiring a passport. All foreign visits must be cleared by the Ministry of External Affairs and if required, from the Ministry of Home Affairs as per the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA). Even when officials go for personal trips, they are